



TRUCK DRIVER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Truck drivers transport goods via local, national, or international road networks. In this role, you may be responsible for planning a delivery schedule and devising a route, keeping an accurate record of trips, checking and maintaining your vehicle, and loading and unloading items. With additional licenses you can drive specialized trucks, such as tankers and hazardous-substance vehicles.



SALARY

Novice truck driver ★★★★★

Experienced truck driver ★★★☆☆

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Employers range from small haulage companies to multinational logistics firms • High demand for truck drivers • Union jobs command highest pay levels

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Driving • Transportation • Travel and distribution • Motor vehicle engineering • Vehicle mechanics • Health and safety



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS While there are no formal educational requirements, a full driving license is required to start training as a truck driver.



LIFESTYLE Driving hours are regulated, with rest breaks required for safety. Most drivers work 42 hours a week, driving by day or night as required.



LOCATION Truck drivers spend the majority of their driving time inside the truck's cab. Long periods away from home are common.



THE REALITIES Driving long-distance is physically exhausting, and overtime pay can be limited. Long periods of time may be spent away from home.

CAREER PATHS

A full car driving license is required before taking the specialized theory and practical examinations required to gain a truck driver's license. After qualifying, it is common for drivers to move between employers in different sectors.

HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATE

You can become a truck driver from the age of 18. Studying mechanics or transportation at high school or college may improve your prospects.



CAREER CHANGER You can take the various truck driver's tests while working in another job, then switch careers once you have the necessary qualifications.

